



Ingest Pilot — Quick Start

Copy your camera media, prove every file arrived, and land it in organized folders — every time.

v0.1.13

New here? This guide gets you from a full camera card to a **verified, organized project** in one pass — then explains the two ideas that make it tick: the **Ingest** screen, and **presets** (with **tokens**). The short version: pick a preset, and most decisions are already made for you.

DO THIS Your first verified ingest, in 7 steps

1 Open Ingest Media

Click **Ingest Media** in the sidebar (or **Start** on Home).

2 Pick a preset

Choose your recipe in the left column. Folders, names, and routing are now set.

3 Copy From

Insert a card (auto-detected) or click **Pick** to choose a folder. Add more with **+**.

4 Project Folder → add a backup

Set **Copy To**, then **+** **Add backup**. Each destination gets its own verified copy.

5 Scan, then Choose files

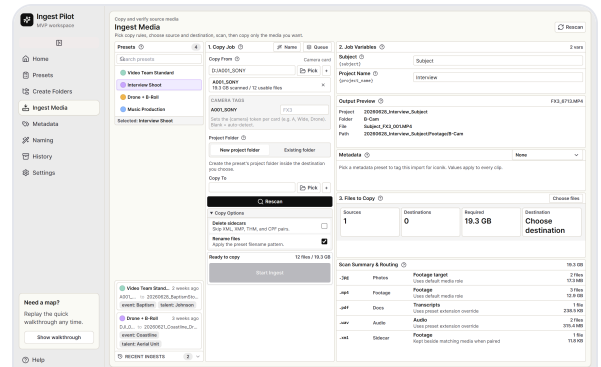
Scan previews the plan without copying. **Choose files** to take the whole card or just the keepers.

6 Start Ingest

Check the **Ready to copy** count, then click **Start Ingest**.

7 Let it copy & verify

It copies, then re-reads every file to prove it's identical. Walk away.



The Ingest screen. Presets on the left · the copy job in the middle · live preview & file list on the right.

Good to know: Ingest Pilot **never modifies or deletes your source card** — it only reads. And the **Output Preview** shows the exact folder and file names before you copy a single byte.

The Ingest screen is three columns. You work left-to-right: choose the **recipe**, describe the **copy job**, then review the **preview & files** before you start.

1 • LEFT Presets

Presets

Your saved recipes. Pick one — the footer shows **Selected:** ... **Recent ingests** below lets you replay a past job.

2 • MIDDLE Copy Job

Copy From

Your source(s). A camera card auto-fills with a **Camera card** badge; or **Pick** a folder; or drag one in. **Camera tags** set the `{camera}` label per card.

Project Folder

New project folder builds the preset's tree inside a location you pick; **Existing folder** copies into one you made.

Copy To + backups

Your destination, plus **+ Add backup**. Every destination is copied *and verified* at once.

Scan

Reads the source without copying and shows the plan.

Copy Options

Rename files (apply the name pattern) and **Delete sidecars** (off by default).

Start Ingest

The **Ready to copy** box confirms count + size. Click to begin.

3 • RIGHT Preview & files

Job Variables

The per-job fields your preset asks for (project name, etc.). These feed the names.

Output Preview

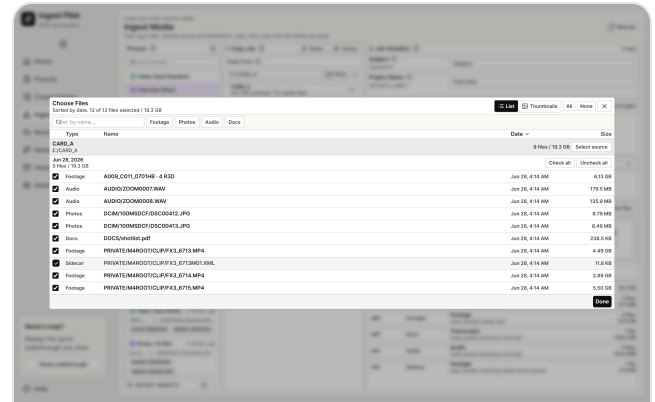
The real resolved **Project / Folder / File / Path** before you copy.

Files to Copy

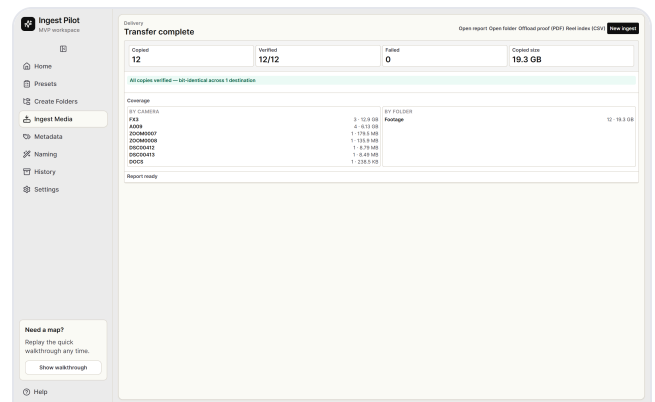
Choose files opens the picker; tiles show sources, destinations, size, and free space.

Scan Summary & Routing

Which file types land in which folders.



Choose Files. Take the whole card or just the keepers — filter by type, pick a whole day, and multi-part clips collapse to one row. Sidecars ride along automatically.



Transfer complete. Every file verified — plus links to the report, offload-proof PDF, reel index, and the folder.

✓ Why "verified" matters

- **Copied ≠ safe.** Ingest Pilot re-reads every copied file and checksum-compares it to the original. Only a match counts as done.
- **Two places at once.** Add a backup destination and both are verified before you eject the card.

A **preset** is a saved workflow: the folder tree, the naming rules, where each file type goes, the fields to fill per job, and the default destinations. Build it once; every ingest that uses it comes out identical. Most people just *use* presets — whoever sets them up edits them here.

Identity

Name, description, and a color swatch.

Project Folder Name

The pattern for the top-level project folder (built from tokens).

Copied File Name

The pattern applied to files as they land.

Pre-folder path

Optional tokenized parent path, e.g.
`{year}/Bro11` (year-aware destinations).

Project Variables

The fields filled per job — each has a `{token}` you can use in names.

Folder Tree

The folders to create; one is the **footage target**. Folders can carry their own rename & metadata.

Routing

Which extensions go to which folders.

Sidcars / Rename / Metadata

Defaults for this preset, plus an attached metadata set.

VARIABLES Where your tokens come from

Project Variables ?

+ Add

Title	Token	Type	Default / Options	Required	Order
Project Name	project_name	Text ▼	Project	☒	↑ ↓ 🗑
Shoot Type	shoot_type	List ▼	Interview, Broll, Event, Story	☐	↑ ↓ 🗑

Each variable has a **Title** (what the user sees), a **Token** (what you put in names, like `{project_name}`), a **Type** (Text, List, Yes/No, Date), and a default. Here, filling "Project Name" sets the `{project_name}` token everywhere it's used.

Reuse it everywhere: presets can be **Duplicated**, **Exported**, and **Imported** as portable files — build one on your machine and share it with the whole team.

A **token** is a placeholder in a name, written like `{year}` or `{camera}`. You build a **pattern** out of tokens and plain text; at ingest time each token is replaced with a real value. Same pattern, consistent names — no guesswork.

IN THE APP

Pills, buttons & a live preview

Project Folder Name ⓘ

+ New naming preset

`{date}` - `{project_name}`

Preview 2026-04-24_Project

+ Date + Year + Month + Day + Preset + Project Name + Shoot Type

Copied File Name ⓘ

`{project_name}` - `{camera}` - `{clip#}`

Preview Project_FX3_001

+ Date + Year + Month + Day + Preset + Project Name + Shoot Type + Camera

+ Clip # + Original + Capture Date + Extension + Folder

Tokens show as **blue pills**. Click the buttons underneath to insert one, or type `$` in the field to search. The **Preview** line always shows the resolved result.

EXAMPLE

Pattern → result

FOLDER

`{date}` - `{project_name}`

▼ resolves to

NAME

2026-06-28_Interview

FILE

`{project_name}` - `{camera}` - `{clip#}`

▼ resolves to

NAME

Interview_FX3_001.MP4

Clean by default: tokens you leave blank drop their separator too, so you never get stray `_` in a name. The `{ext}` is added for you.

REFERENCE

The tokens you'll use

Token	Becomes	Works in
DATE & PRESET — work anywhere		
<code>{date}</code>	Today's date, e.g. 2026-06-28	folder & file names
<code>{year}</code> <code>{month}</code> <code>{day}</code>	The parts of the date, zero-padded	folder & file names
<code>{preset_name}</code>	The preset's name	folder & file names
YOUR PROJECT VARIABLES — you fill these per job		
<code>{project_name}</code> , <code>{campus}</code> ...	Whatever your preset defines (from the Variables table)	folder & file names
PER-CLIP — file names only		
<code>{camera}</code>	The card's camera tag, e.g. FX3	file names
<code>{clip#}</code>	Auto counter: 001, 002, 003...	file names
<code>{original}</code>	The camera's original filename	file names
<code>{capture_date}</code>	When the clip was actually shot	file names
<code>{ext}</code>	The extension (.mov, .mp4) — added automatically	file names
FOLDER — file names only		
<code>{folder}</code>	The folder a file lands in (so files inherit the folder's name)	file names

FAST

Jump anywhere with the keyboard

⌘/Ctrl 1 Home

⌘/Ctrl 2 Presets

⌘/Ctrl 3 Create Folders

⌘/Ctrl 4 Ingest

⌘/Ctrl 5 Metadata

⌘/Ctrl 6 Naming

⌘/Ctrl 7 History

⌘/Ctrl 8 Settings

⌘/Ctrl , Settings

Stuck? The **Help** button is at the bottom of the sidebar, and **Show walkthrough** replays the intro any time. Prefer templates? The **Naming** tab builds correct project names from a template — fill a field or two and it does the formatting.

